DRILL 12

SEARCH & RESCUE

NFPA 1001 Level 1 (JPR 4.3.9) / WorkSafeNB Reg 91-191

PRIMARY SEARCH TECHNIQUES & ORIENTED SEARCH

⏱ **Time:** 45–60 min | 🚒 **Apparatus:** Any Engine/Rescue | 🦺 **PPE:** Full Structural Turnout Gear & SCBA

👥 **Roles:** Drill Leader (Facilitator) | Safety Officer (Watcher) | 2-Firefighter Search Teams

🎯 OBJECTIVE & RURAL FIREGROUND VALUE

Every firefighter must be able to conduct a rapid, disciplined **Primary Search** in an unfamiliar structure under zero-visibility conditions, maintaining continuous orientation using either a perimeter **Wall Search (Left/Right Hand)** or a **Tool-Assisted Oriented Search**, locating a victim and communicating findings without becoming disoriented.

📦 TOOLS & APPARATUS SETUP

- Apparatus bay, meeting room, or storage area configured with simulated residential furniture (chairs, tables, pallets, mattresses).
- Rescue mannequin or weighted dummy (50–150 lbs).
- Flash hoods reversed over SCBA facepieces to simulate zero visibility (smoke).
- Hand tools: Halligan bar, 6-ft pike pole / NY hook, flashlight, Thermal Imaging Camera (TIC).

⚠️ SAFETY WATCH-OUTS & STOP RULE

⚠️ **WorkSafeNB 51.6(2) Compliance:** No firefighter searches alone. Partners must maintain voice, visual, or physical contact at all times.

⚠️ **Trip & Snag Hazards:** Searchers must stay low (crawling or tripod position). Watch for head-strikes against overhead framing or tables.

🛑 **THE STOP RULE: Shout "STOP!" immediately if searchers lose orientation, if a member experiences real panic, or if someone steps off a simulated ledge/stairwell.**

PHASE 1: SEARCH PHILOSOPHY & TECHNIQUES (10 MINUTES) — SLOW DRY RUN

1. **The Tripod / Crawl Position:**
   - One knee on the floor, one foot forward with boot out in front, head up, reaching forward with hand/tool.
   - Feeling the floor ahead before putting weight down prevents falling through burnt floorboards or down open stairwells!
2. **Oriented Search vs Perimeter Search:**
   - **Wall Search:** One partner maintains hand/foot contact with the exterior wall (Right-Hand or Left-Hand pattern), sweeping room perimeter and beds.
   - **Oriented Search (Preferred Modern Method):**
   - **Oriented Firefighter (Team Lead):** Stays at the doorway of the room with the TIC and flashlight. Monitors air, hallway conditions, and orientation.
   - **Searcher:** Moves into the room, sweeps the space using a hand tool to extend reach by 6 feet, sweeps around and under beds, returns directly to the oriented firefighter's voice and light at the door.

DRILL 12: PRACTICAL EVOLUTIONS & TAILGATE DEBRIEF Search & Rescue • Practical Application

PHASE 2: SLOW WALKTHROUGH & SOUNDING THE FLOOR (15 MINUTES) — BUDDY COACHING

1. Pair teams up.
2. Practice entering a room:
   - Sweep the threshold immediately inside the door (victims often collapse right behind doors!).
   - Chock the door open so it cannot latch behind you.
   - Sweep sweeping arcs with the halligan or pike pole handle across the floor, under furniture, and along walls.
   - Listen periodically: Pause for 3 seconds, call out *"FIRE DEPARTMENT! ANYONE HERE?"*, and listen for groans, coughing, or tapping.

PHASE 3: ZERO-VISIBILITY SCENARIO (25 MINUTES) — TIMED / STRESS

1. Reverse flash hoods over facepieces. Search teams start at the exterior "doorway".
2. Team must:
   - Communicate search pattern: *"Engine 1 entering, conducting Left-Hand search!"*
   - Search room systematically, locating the simulated victim.
   - When victim is found, call out loudly: *"VICTIM FOUND! BEDROOM 1!"*
   - Formulate extraction plan (which exit is closest).
   - Drag victim back along the wall to the entry door.
3. Debrief time elapsed and air consumed (PSI check).

⚠️ COMMON PITFALLS & FIREGROUND HAZARDS

- ❌ *Leaving the wall without a reference tool:* If both searchers drift into the center of a smoke-filled room, disorientation occurs in seconds. Stay anchored to a wall, line, or your oriented partner!
- ❌ *Passing doors without checking:* Skipping a closed door leaves a fire or a trapped victim behind you.
- ❌ *Searching too fast / missing under beds:* Children and pets hide in closets, under beds, and behind curtains. Sweep completely under furniture before moving past.

🗣️ 5-MINUTE TAILGATE DEBRIEF

1. ***"Did the team maintain communication during the search?", "How much air did you consume during 10 minutes of crawling?"***

✅ APPARATUS RESET CHECKLIST

- ☐ Mannequins and furniture returned to staging areas.
- ☐ Hand tools wiped clean and stowed in apparatus mounts.
- ☐ SCBA facepieces cleaned, disinfected, and dried.
- ☐ Spare cylinders refilled.
- ☐ Attendance roster signed.

DRILL LEADER SIGNATURE	SAFETY OFFICER SIGNATURE	DATE COMPLETED	TRAINING HOURS